

Usability Testing Document SweetLedger



SWEETLEDGER

Version 1.2 (Updated as of 11/25/25)

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Kennesaw State University

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this usability testing document is to get a better understanding of how well external customers and consumers of SweetLedger will use the system. Sweetledger's goal is to provide an efficient and alternative financial ledger system that our users will enjoy using. SweetLedger is to be easy to pick up and learn, and we pride ourselves in saying that any one with various technological adeptness will be able to correctly use SweetLedger.

These usability tests measure the time it takes to perform various tasks. Also in these usability tests are surveyed questions asking how the participants approved of our UI schema, and how easy or difficult it was to traverse the system. Sweetledger consists of three roles, (Administrator, Manager, and Accountant) so each participant's experience was different. Further along this document is a blank test to use as reference along with the responses from three randomly selected individuals. Please note that these tests are slightly configured for each role (Administrator, Manager, and Accountant) to best fit these roles during the performed tests.

1.2 Participants

These usability tests were performed by three individuals. All of the individuals agreed to have their information shared in this document so the reader and client can understand their technological adeptness. The Sweetledger team agreed it would be best to have participants of varying tech-usage in their everyday lives.

The first participant was Parker Knight. Parker is a Gulfstream private aircraft manufacturer in Savannah, Georgia. His duties rarely require him to utilize technology, so we chose him to perform the usability test under the "Manager" role in the SweetLedger software.

The second participant was Capt. John Augustyniak. John is a fishing charter captain and an employee of the Georgia Ports Authority in Thunderbolt, Georgia. He often uses technology similar to Sweetledger in his everyday life, so he was chosen to complete the usability test under the "Accountant" role in Sweetledger.

The third participant was Carson Tutor. Carson is a mechanical engineering student at Georgia Southern University in Statesboro, Georgia. Out of all three individuals that tested Sweetledger, he is the most technologically adept. He was chosen to perform the test under the "Administrator" role in Sweetledger.

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SWEETLEDGER

BLANK ROLE
Testing Document

Name:

Role Testing:

Task 1:

Select “Create New Account” on the starting page. Enter in the prompted information such as your name, date of birth, and address. Enter in the test holder’s email (matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com). After this, ensure the username field is filled and enter a password. Select the “Submit Request” button once complete.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 2:

Sign into Sweetledger using your username and password.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 3: Explore the Landing Page of Sweetledger. What is the first thing that sticks out to you? What improvements can be made to improve usability?

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 4: Select the “Chart of Accounts” button in the dashboard. Explore the page. First, filter the accounts to and type in Account Name “Cash” to find the Cash account. Second, filter the accounts and type in Account Number “2101” to find the appropriate account.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 5: While still in the Chart of Accounts page, select the email link that is near the top of the page. Enter in the test holder’s email, matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com, and enter in any subject and message into the line. Ensure the test holder received the email.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 6: Press the “Dashboard” button near the top of the page, and now select the “Journalize” button near the top of the dashboard page. Select the “+ New Entry” button at the top of this page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 7: Once in the New Entry section of the Journal page, create a new journal entry. Do this by selecting to debit the Cash account by exactly \$100.00. Then select to credit the Contributed Capital account by exactly \$90.00. Enter “Usability Test” for the journal entry description. Write what happens in the system in this task’s comments below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 8: Once in the New Entry section of the Journal page, create a new journal entry. Do this by selecting to debit the Cash account by exactly \$100.00. Then select to credit the Contributed Capital account by exactly \$100.00. Enter “Usability Test” for the journal entry description. Write what happens in the system in this task’s comments below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 9: Still in the Journalize page, select the “Approved” button to see all of the approved journal entries. Scroll to the bottom of the page until you see the approved journal entry titled “JE-61ec9d” created by user jdeer1025. Select the “View” button to see the details of the journal entry.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 10: While viewing the details of the journal entry you selected, press the link for account number “1506”. Explain what happens in the system when you press this link.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 11: Return to the dashboard of Sweetledger. Navigate the dashboard and select the “Financial Reports” button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 12: You will now see the ability to generate four various financial reports. Select “Trial Balance” in the dropdown and press “Generate Report”. Then, select “Income Statement” in the dropdown and ensure the Start Date is exactly 04/04/2025 before you select “Generate Report”. Then, select “Balance Sheet” in the dropdown and select “Generate Report”. Then, select “Statement of Retained Earnings” in the dropdown and ensure the Start Date is exactly 04/04/2025 before you select “Generate Report”.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant’s Comments:

Task 13: After you have generated the Statement of Retained Earnings report, Save and print the report to the computer.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 14: After you have completed the Financial Reports tasks, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard. Once on the dashboard, Select the "Event Log" button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 15: After you are done exploring the system's event logs, return to the dashboard. Press the calendar button near the top of the page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 16: After viewing the calendar, find the information button to learn more about the SweetLedger financial system. This button is on every page of SweetLedger, but you will be finding this button on the dashboard.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 17: Once you have found the SweetLedger information button navigate to the "Account Management" button in the dashboard. Write in the comments section for this task what you see.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 18: Once you are done in the Account Management page, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard and find the "Logout" button and press it.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 19: Attempt to sign back into your account, but this time use an incorrect password with your correct account username. Write your findings in the comment section for this task below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

Task 20: Sign back into your account. Once you sign in, see how long it takes you to get to view the details of Post Reference JE-1 of account 5006-Utilities Expense.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

Participant's Comments:

End-of-Test Findings (For Tester):

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SWEETLEDGER

Manager Role
Testing Document

Name:

Parker Knight

Role Testing:

Manager

Task 1:

Select “Create New Account” on the starting page. Enter in the prompted information such as your name, date of birth, and address. Enter in the test holder’s email (matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com). After this, ensure the username field is filled and enter a password. Select the “Submit Request” button once complete.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:41

Participant’s Comments:

It was easy.

Task 2:

Sign into Sweetledger using your username and password.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:12

Participant’s Comments:

It was easy

Task 3: Explore the Landing Page of Sweetledger. What is the first thing that sticks out to you? What improvements can be made to improve usability?

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:36

Participant’s Comments:

The buttons at the top of the page, the numbers in the middle of the screen, and then the big buttons telling me where I go. I have no suggestions.

Task 4: Select the “Chart of Accounts” button in the dashboard. Explore the page. First, filter the accounts to and type in Account Name “Cash” to find the Cash account. Second, filter the accounts and type in Account Number “2101” to find the appropriate account.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:40

Participant’s Comments:

Its cool that you can easily find every account by searching for it.

Task 5: While still in the Chart of Accounts page, select the email link that is near the top of the page. Enter in the test holder’s email, matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com, and enter in any subject and message into the line. Ensure the test holder received the email.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:50

Participant’s Comments:

It was easy to send the email

Task 6: Press the “Dashboard” button near the top of the page, and now select the “Journalize” button near the top of the dashboard page. Select the “+ New Entry” button at the top of this page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:24

Participant’s Comments:

Finding the button was easy

Task 7: Once in the New Entry section of the Journal page, create a new journal entry. Do this by selecting to debit the Cash account by exactly \$100.00. Then select to credit the Contributed Capital account by exactly \$90.00. Enter “Usability Test” for the journal entry description. Write what happens in the system in this task’s comments below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:57

Participant’s Comments:

It was self-explanatory when doing that. It did not let me create it because it said they were not equal.

Task 8: Once in the New Entry section of the Journal page, create a new journal entry. Do this by selecting to debit the Cash account by exactly \$100.00. Then select to credit the Contributed Capital account by exactly \$100.00. Enter “Usability Test” for the journal entry description. Write what happens in the system in this task’s comments below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:30

Participant’s Comments:

It was also self-explanatory to do that and it let me create it

Task 9: Still in the Journalize page, select the “Approved” button to see all of the approved journal entries. Scroll to the bottom of the page until you see the approved journal entry titled “JE-61ec9d” created by user jdeer1025. Select the “View” button to see the details of the journal entry.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:18

Participant's Comments:

The directions of the test are good I'm not sure I would find it without them it was easy to find though

Task 10: While viewing the details of the journal entry you selected, press the link for account number "1506". Explain what happens in the system when you press this link.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:08

Participant's Comments:

I was taken to a ledger screen and I saw different entries and money going into and out an account

Task 11: Return to the dashboard of Sweetledger. Navigate the dashboard and select the "Financial Reports" button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:03

Participant's Comments:

Finding the Financial Reports screen was easy for me

Task 12: You will now see the ability to generate four various financial reports. Select "Trial Balance" in the dropdown and press "Generate Report". Then, select "Income Statement" in the dropdown and ensure the Start Date is exactly 04/04/2025 before you select "Generate Report". Then, select "Balance Sheet" in the dropdown and select "Generate Report". Then, select "Statement of Retained Earnings" in the dropdown and ensure the Start Date is exactly 04/04/2025 before you select "Generate Report".

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:50

Participant's Comments:

Making the reports was easy and the drop down button really helped.

Task 13: After you have generated the Statement of Retained Earnings report, Save and print the report to the computer.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:11

Participant's Comments:

Its cool that you can save the reports to your own computer

Task 14: After you have completed the Financial Reports tasks, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard. Once on the dashboard, Select the "Event Log" button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:07

Participant's Comments:

It looks incomplete right now but maybe the different version has it better

Task 15: After you are done exploring the system's event logs, return to the dashboard. Press the calendar button near the top of the page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:03

Participant's Comments:

The calendar looks good

Task 16: After viewing the calendar, find the information button to learn more about the SweetLedger financial system. This button is on every page of SweetLedger, but you will be finding this button on the dashboard.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:49

Participant's Comments:

The button was self explanatory because it was in the corner and had a ? mark. It took me a long time to read all of the information but it is good for learning more about it.

Task 17: Once you have found the SweetLedger information button navigate to the "Account Management" button in the dashboard. Write in the comments section for this task what you see.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:17

Participant's Comments:

I see all of the accounts that are there and their roles.

Task 18: Once you are done in the Account Management page, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard and find the "Logout" button and press it.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:06

Participant's Comments:

The logout button was exactly where I thought it would be. And it was red so it was easy to see.

Task 19: Attempt to sign back into your account, but this time use an incorrect

password with your correct account username. Write your findings in the comment section for this task below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:21

Participant's Comments:

It told me the system had 2 more attempts to get my password right

Task 20: Sign back into your account. Once you sign in, see how long it takes you to get to view the details of Post Reference JE-1 of account 5006-Utilities Expense.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:59

Participant's Comments:

It was difficult for me because I went to the account management section first but then I went to the chart of accounts section and was able to find it better

End-of-Test Findings (For Tester):

The system is fine, I was able to find all of the buttons with ease and it looks like any other real website to me. I like the current website.

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SWEETLEDGER

Accountant Role
Testing Document

Name:

Captain Augie

Role Testing:

Accountant

Task 1:

Select "Create New Account" on the starting page. Enter in the prompted information such as your name, date of birth, and address. Enter in the test holder's email (matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com). After this, ensure the username field is filled and enter a password. Select the "Submit Request" button once complete.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:40

Participant's Comments:

Creating an account for the website was fine and easy, I wonder how hard it would be to have a confirm password option when creating an account

Task 2:

Sign into Sweetledger using your username and password.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:11

Participant's Comments:

Signing in was easy after my account got created

Task 3: Explore the Landing Page of Sweetledger. What is the first thing that sticks out to you? What improvements can be made to improve usability?

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:31

Participant's Comments:

The first thing that stuck out to me was the ratios and the red and the green. Also the big buttons telling me where I could go on the site. I cannot think of how I would do it better.

Task 4: Select the “Chart of Accounts” button in the dashboard. Explore the page. First, filter the accounts to and type in Account Name “Cash” to find the Cash account. Second, filter the accounts and type in Account Number “2101” to find the appropriate account.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):
0:36

Participant’s Comments:
It’s nice to be able to search for all of the accounts on the site.

Task 5: While still in the Chart of Accounts page, select the email link that is near the top of the page. Enter in the test holder’s email, matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com, and enter in any subject and message into the line. Ensure the test holder received the email.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):
0:43

Participant’s Comments:
It’s actually awesome that you can send emails right from the site, I don’t see that in many other websites.

Task 6: Press the “Dashboard” button near the top of the page, and now select the “Journalize” button near the top of the dashboard page. Select the “+ New Entry” button at the top of this page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):
0:15

Participant's Comments:

Finding the new entry was easy.

Task 7: Once in the New Entry section of the Journal page, create a new journal entry. Do this by selecting to debit the Cash account by exactly \$100.00. Then select to credit the Contributed Capital account by exactly \$90.00. Enter "Usability Test" for the journal entry description. Write what happens in the system in this task's comments below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:41

Participant's Comments:

I like how it warned me that the numbers were not equal and did not let me submit it

Task 8: Once in the New Entry section of the Journal page, create a new journal entry. Do this by selecting to debit the Cash account by exactly \$100.00. Then select to credit the Contributed Capital account by exactly \$100.00. Enter "Usability Test" for the journal entry description. Write what happens in the system in this task's comments below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:34

Participant's Comments:

It created the journal entry

Task 9: Still in the Journalize page, select the "Approved" button to see all of the approved journal entries. Scroll to the bottom of the page until you see the approved journal entry titled "JE-61ec9d" created by user jdeer1025. Select the "View" button to see the details of the journal entry.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:18

Participant's Comments:

I like how all of the entries are labeled on whether they are approved or not. The information about each one is also nice to know.

Task 10: While viewing the details of the journal entry you selected, press the link for account number "1506". Explain what happens in the system when you press this link.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:07

Participant's Comments:

I see the details of the account

Task 11: Return to the dashboard of Sweetledger. Navigate the dashboard and select the "Financial Reports" button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:04

Participant's Comments:

Having all of the things you can do in the site all in one place is nice because you don't got to run around the whole site trying to find stuff.

Task 12: You will now see the ability to generate four various financial reports. Select "Trial Balance" in the dropdown and press "Generate Report". Then, select "Income Statement" in the dropdown and ensure the Start Date is exactly 04/04/2025 before you select "Generate Report". Then, select "Balance Sheet" in the dropdown and select "Generate Report". Then, select "Statement of Retained Earnings" in the dropdown and ensure the Start Date is exactly 04/04/2025 before you select "Generate Report".

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:45

Participant's Comments:

All of these reports look nice and it is interesting how yall did the math behind it

Task 13: After you have generated the Statement of Retained Earnings report, Save and print the report to the computer.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:10

Participant's Comments:

It is quite fascinating how yall made it so you can save all these to your computer.

Task 14: After you have completed the Financial Reports tasks, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard. Once on the dashboard, Select the "Event Log" button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:03

Participant's Comments:

Again, all of the things you can do are right there at the top of the home screen, finding the event log was easy.

Task 15: After you are done exploring the system's event logs, return to the dashboard. Press the calendar button near the top of the page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:05

Participant's Comments:

The calendar was exactly where I thought it would be

Task 16: After viewing the calendar, find the information button to learn more about the SweetLedger financial system. This button is on every page of SweetLedger, but you will be finding this button on the dashboard.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:02

Participant's Comments:

The button was right where I thought it would be, and the ? mark made it easy to understand what it was.

Task 17: Once you have found the SweetLedger information button navigate to the "Account Management" button in the dashboard. Write in the comments section for this task what you see.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:06

Participant's Comments:

I see a nice list of all the site users and what their role is

Task 18: Once you are done in the Account Management page, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard and find the "Logout" button and press it.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:03

Participant's Comments:

The log out button is where I would expect it to be and it is red which stuck out to me

Task 19: Attempt to sign back into your account, but this time use an incorrect password with your correct account username. Write your findings in the comment section for this task below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:16

Participant's Comments:

I forgot my password so I had to ask the test holder but the site told me that it was wrong

Task 20: Sign back into your account. Once you sign in, see how long it takes you to get to view the details of Post Reference JE-1 of account 5006-Utilities Expense.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:43

Participant's Comments:

It took me about 15 seconds after I signed in to find what I was supposed to

End-of-Test Findings (For Tester):

I found the site very easy to know where I was at and what I was doing. The colors fit well across the whole site and I would use this if it were a real website.

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SWEETLEDGER

Administrator Role
Testing Document

Name:

Carson

Role Testing:

Admin

Task 1:

Select "Create New Account" on the starting page. Enter in the prompted information such as your name, date of birth, and address. Enter in the test holder's email (matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com). After this, ensure the username field is filled and enter a password. Select the "Submit Request" button once complete.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:33

Participant's Comments:

The sign up feature is similar to many other websites. However, I wish there was another text field where I needed to enter in my password more than once.

Task 2:

Sign into Sweetledger using your username and password.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:09

Participant's Comments:

This feature works correctly and it signed me into my account.

Task 3: Explore the Landing Page of Sweetledger. What is the first thing that sticks out to you? What improvements can be made to improve usability?

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:10

Participant's Comments:

I like the color scheme of Sweetledger. It is not a plain black and white boring app, it actually has charm to it with being primarily orange in color. I like the logo. The tab bar is well done. I have no critiques of the home page.

Task 4: Select the “Chart of Accounts” button in the dashboard. Explore the page. First, filter the accounts to and type in Account Name “Cash” to find the Cash account. Second, filter the accounts and type in Account Number “2101” to find the appropriate account.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):
0:10

Participant’s Comments:

The filter feature is correct and reliable. I was able to find the accounts in the task easily.

Task 5: While still in the Chart of Accounts page, select the email link that is near the top of the page. Enter in the test holder’s email, matthewcrowley2002@gmail.com, and enter in any subject and message into the line. Ensure the test holder received the email.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):
0:17

Participant’s Comments:

I successfully sent the email, and it is honestly better than most applications that I use.

Task 6: Return to the dashboard, and select the “Event Log” button.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):
0:03

Participant’s Comments:

All of the app's features are easy to navigate to from the home page in the tab section. This is a fantastic spot to have all of these buttons.

Task 7: After you are done exploring the system's event logs, return to the dashboard. Press the calendar button near the top of the page.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:02

Participant's Comments:

The calendar is in a nice spot and looks great.

Task 8: After viewing the calendar, find the information button to learn more about the SweetLedger financial system. This button is on every page of SweetLedger, but you will be finding this button on the dashboard.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:01

Participant's Comments:

The information button is in a great spot too.

Task 9: Once you have found the SweetLedger information button navigate to the "Account Management" button in the dashboard. Write in the comments section for this task what you see.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:18

Participant's Comments:

I see all of the app's users and their roles. I also see all of the financial accounts that are in the app. I see buttons of actions that I can take on all of the users as an admin. The colors of the buttons are nice and stand out.

Task 10: Once you are done in the Account Management page, navigate back to the SweetLedger dashboard and find the “Logout” button and press it.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:04

Participant’s Comments:

The log out button is in the perfect spot in the top right corner near my account information. I also like how it is red so that it stands out.

Task 11: Attempt to sign back into your account, but this time use an incorrect password with your correct account username. Write your findings in the comment section for this task below.

Time taken to complete task (Test Holder):

0:09

Participant’s Comments:

The app did not let me sign in when I entered incorrect information.

End-of-Test Findings (For Tester):

I approve of the flow of Sweetledger. I really liked the home page, it was clear what I could and couldn’t do. The color scheme is also different but in a good way. It is not a boring black and white, I do not like minimalism in terms of colors. Sweetledger is a very good application made by the team. It was easy completing all of the tasks and I did them without trouble.

3. Conclusion

3.1 Findings

Based on the findings and results of these usability tests, the Sweetledger team is very pleased to know that they have created an efficient financial accounting system. Every single task was completed in under a minute, and the shorter tasks were completed in under 10 seconds and sometimes even under 5 seconds. We learned that our buttons were often placed in the perfect position on the screen for the user to efficiently do their work. We could have more definitive results of the flow of Sweetledger if we tested on more individuals.

3.2 Closing Thoughts

The goal of these usability tests was not necessarily to test the completeness of official features of the system, but to test the flow and usability of it. Although we have more bugs to fix and final features to implement, we are very pleased with how Sweetledger flows for all users and how it looks. The usability tests prove that completing tasks in the system is efficient and does not give users trouble.